LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFILE

Data engineer with 9 years of experience building batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce and payments. I like boring, well-tested pipelines, clear data contracts and warehouses that analysts actually trust.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka
03/2022 - present

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Moved transformation logic from stored procedures to dbt (420+ models, tests on every model); nightly run time down from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline (Kafka Connect + Snowpipe Streaming) for shipment tracking events, ~30M events/day.
- Reduced Snowflake costs from about $38k to $24k/month through warehouse sizing and auto-suspend.
- Take part in the data-platform on-call rotation (one week in six).
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR for transaction reconciliation (daily ~1.2 TB of raw files from S3).
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data: Airflow, dbt, Spark (PySpark), Kafka, Kafka Connect, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations
Cloud & infra: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)